Prashant Garg

Curriculum Vitae

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Summary

I'm a postdoctoral researcher at Bocconi University and an Associate Fellow at INET Oxford. I completed my PhD in Economics and Public Policy at Imperial College London.
My research focuses on economic and social measurement, using machine learning, econometrics, and network science. I am interested in science and innovation, economic and social networks, production, and information and media.

Publications

1. **Political Expression of Academics on Twitter.** Joint with Thiemo Fetzer. *Nature Human Behaviour*. 2025. Paper. Project website.
2. **Local Decline and Populism.** Joint with Thiemo Fetzer and Jacob Edenhofer. *Economics Letters*. 2025. Paper.
3. **Uneven Patterns of Cross-Border Media Coverage Following Natural Disasters.** Joint with Thiemo Fetzer. *Nature Human Behaviour*. 2026. Paper.
4. **How much do language and context affect the accuracy of AI health advice?** Joint with Thiemo Fetzer. *BMJ Health & Care Informatics*. 2026. Paper.

Revise and Resubmit

1. **Simple Contagion Drives Population-Scale Platform Migration.** Joint with Dorian Quelle, Frederic Denker and Alexandre Bovet. *Nature Communications*. Revise and resubmit. Paper. *Best Student Paper, NetSciSci2025.*
2. **Health shocks reallocate the direction of medical research.** Joint with Hongyu Zhou and Thiemo Fetzer. *Nature Health*. Revise and resubmit. Preprint.

Working Papers

1. **Global Automation Atlas.** Joint with Tommaso Crosta and Jasmin Baier. Paper.
2. **Causal Claims in Economics.** Joint with Thiemo Fetzer. Paper and www.causal.claims (open data). Coverage by Financial Times, The Economist, World Bank, VoxDev, Australian Treasury, and Nada es Gratis.
3. **Measuring the Prevalence and Direction of Innovation: A Pilot Approach Using LLMs.** Joint with Peter John Lambert, Ralf Martin and Denis Medvedev. *CEP Discussion Paper No. 2216, September 2026.* Paper. CEP record.
4. **What Should Economics Ask Next?** Paper.
5. **Politicized Scientists: Credibility Cost of Political Expression on Twitter.** Joint with Eleonora Alabrese and Francesco Capozza. Paper. Coverage by Times Higher Education, American Saga, University of Bath, Nada es Gratis, A Fuoco, iL Post
6. **AI-Generated Production Networks: Measurement and Applications to Global Trade.** Joint with Thiemo Fetzer, Peter John Lambert, Bennet Feld. Paper and aipnet.io (open data). Coverage: Interview with South China Morning Post, The Ecologist.

Policy Writings

1. **Leveraging large language models for large-scale information retrieval in economics.** 2025 VoxEU
2. **Structural transformation of public space: High-street changes and populism.** 2025 VoxEU
3. **Political expression of academics on social media.** 2024 VoxEU
4. **How to preserve academic credibility when engaging on social media.** 2024 Times Higher Education
5. **Leveraging AI to navigate deglobalisation.** 2024 VoxEU
6. **Causal claims in economics.** 2024 VoxEU

Other Writings

1. **Mapping Bob Dylan's Mind** Essay in *Aeon Magazine* 2025. (+ Underlying scientific Paper)

Public Goods & Open Data

1. **Global Automation Atlas.** Automation exposure measured task by task across 124 countries. automationatlas.org
2. **Frontier Graph.** Organizing open questions in economics. frontiergraph.com
3. **Causal Claims in Economics** (45K papers): open datasets, code, graph-driven research assistant, and your causal graph. www.causal.claims
4. **Political Scientists Panel** (Stance and Behaviour of 100k+ academics on Twitter): www.academicexpression.online
5. **AIPNET** (Input-output links between 5K HS products): aipnet.io
6. **Retrieving and Generating Data using LLMs.** Github Repository and slides. Guided code for turning raw text into structured, research ready data.

Awards and Prizes

2026 **Astera Essay Competition** ($15,000 award). For *Where Should Science Go Next?*. Competition theme: Identifying Systemic Bottlenecks to Science.

Education

2022–2026 **PhD in Economics and Public Policy**, *Imperial College London*, London, UK

2022 **MRes in Economics**, *Imperial College London*, London, UK
Awards: Distinction.

2019 **MSc. Economics**, *University College London (UCL)*, London, UK

2018 **BSc. Economics**, *Cardiff University*, Cardiff, UK
Awards: First class honour; Helen Robinson Memorial prize for highest score in Microeconomics theory exam.

2015 **International Baccalaureate (IB)**, *GD Goenka World School*, Gurgaon, India
Awards: Chairman's award for highest overall score (43/45 points) in the school, 99th percentile globally.

Work Experience

2026– **Postdoctoral Researcher**, *Bocconi University*, Milan, Italy
Since September 2026.

Current **Associate Fellow**, *INET Oxford*, Oxford, UK

2026 **Research Associate**, *University of Cambridge*, Cambridge
Postdoctoral appointment beginning in May 2026.

2025–Present **Visiting researcher**, *University of Cambridge*, Cambridge
Computer Science Department. Hosted by Neil Lawrence

2024–2025 **Visiting researcher**, *International Finance Corporation (IFC)*, Paris/DC
Part of Economics Research Unit. Hosted by Ralf Martin

2019–2021 **Research and Teaching Assistant ("Predoc")**, *Imperial College London*, London, UK
Research: RA to several faculty in applied microeconomics. *Teaching:* Executive MBA: *managerial economics* (2020, 2021), MSc. Economics & Strategy for Business: *digital economics & strategy* (2020, 2021), Business for Professional Engineers and Scientists (BPES): *managerial economics* (2019, 2020), Joint Honours/BPES: *business economics* (2020, 2021).

2017 **Research Assistant (3 mo.)**, *Institute of Welsh Affairs (policy think tank)*, Cardiff, UK

Conference and Seminar Presentations

2027: STEG Annual Conference & Theme Workshops 2027 (Manchester, 6–9 Jan 2027).

2026: Inaugural IZA@LISER Conference in Labour Economics (Luxembourg, 10–11 Dec 2026); Universitat de València Seminar (València, 4 Dec 2026); European University Institute (Florence, 11 Nov 2026); Innovation Seminar (invited), Collège de France (Paris, 6 Nov 2026); Network Science & Economics (Luxembourg, 23–25 Oct 2026); Bocconi University, PE breakfast (internal) (Milan, 30 Sep 2026); ASREC Europe 2026 Conference (Venice, 25–26 Sep 2026); MPWZ–CEPR Text-as-Data (Virtual, 17–18 Sep 2026); Competition and Markets Authority (CMA); U.S. International Trade Commission; Oxford INET; MPWZ–CEPR Text-as-Data (April); MIT FutureTech.

2025: CEPR Paris Symposium, Oxford Behavioural Economics Group, C-SEB/ECONtribute, Cologne, MPWZ-CEPR Text-As-Data, Networks in Science of Science, LSE QueerConf, PSL Public Governance workshop, Text as Data in Behavioural Economics, EAYE Annual Meeting, AYEW Roundtable Causal ML, Groningen, ZBW, SE-IGC Environmental Populism Conference, Economics of Media Bias Workshop, Workshop for Ukraine, AERE-Osweet, MPWZ-CEPR Text as Data, PolMeth Europe, Text as Data (TaDa) webinar, OECD Trade, UK Treasury, STEG Annual Conference.

2024: CEPR Paris Symposium, Leibniz Open Science Day, UniBZ Workshop on Political Economy, AYEW - AI and Alternative Data, Causal Data Science Meeting, Cambridge Janeway Institute, KIEL-CEPR - Geoeconomics, Advances with Field Experiment, Economics of Digitization (Cesifo), QPE Early Career Workshop, Workshop on the Pol. economy of environmental policy, RES Annual Conference, Ph.D. Workshop in Networks and Political Economy.

2023: Digital Economy Network, AYEW workshop - AI/Text-as-Data Workshop, MWZ Text-as-Data, IBEO Complexity Economics, QMUL Economics and Finance Workshop, RES Easter Training School, Warwick PhD conference

Technical skills

Coding R, Python, SQL, Stata, Matlab, CMD, JS, HTML, Bash/Shell

Tools Google Cloud, AWS, OpenAI, Ollama, GitHub

Service

Referee: British Journal of Political Science, Journal of the European Economic Association

EDI Committee Member, Imperial College Business School (2023-2024)

Chair, PhD Student-Staff Committee, Imperial College Business School (2022-2024)